

David Dubé, PhD Candidate in Political Science — McGill University

CONTACT INFORMATION

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EDUCATION

McGill University, Montréal, QC

PhD candidate, Political Science

Since Fall 2022

- ◇ Supervisor: Juliet Johnson
- ◇ Dissertation: *Crypto at the State's Edge: Bargaining, Legitimacy, and Financial Authority in the Digital Age*
- ◇ Comprehensive exams in Comparative Politics & International Relations
- ◇ Coursework GPA: 3.95/4.0

University of Quebec at Montreal, Montréal, QC

Master of Arts (honors distinction), Political Science

Obtained: January 2022

- ◇ Supervisors: Jacques Lévesque & Christian Deblock
- ◇ Thesis: *The Construction of Russia's Foreign Policy Revanchism: Understanding the Annexation of Crimea*
- ◇ GPA: 4.18/4.3

Bachelor of Arts, Political Science

Obtained: May 2019

- ◇ Exchange semester at the National Research University Higher School of Economics (Moscow)
- ◇ Political Science and Law Students' Association Executive

MAIN POSITIONS

Senior Data Analyst, Global Affairs Canada - Affaires Mondiales Canada, March 2025 - April 2026

- ◇ Member of the Rapid Response Mechanism Data Science and Russia geographic teams. My role is to monitor the digital information space, identify, classify and report on foreign threats and information operations targeting Canada.

Research Team Leader, Canadian Network on Information and Security

Since Fall 2022

- ◇ Research team on Russian & Chinese foreign misinformation studies and machine learning methods research (SSHRC and MINDS programs funded).
- ◇ Dir. Jean-Christophe Boucher PhD - University of Calgary.

Course lecturer, Research and Teaching Assistant

Since Fall 2019

- ◇ **Course lecturer:** Politics in East Central Europe (Fall 2024).
- ◇ **Teaching Assistant:** *McGill University*: Fall 2022 - Now ; *University of Quebec at Montreal*: Fall 2019 - Winter 2022.
- ◇ **Research Assistant** (McGill University):
 - *Prof. Juliet Johnson*: PhD research supervisor; BEAR Network.
 - *Prof. Aaron Erlich*: Centre for the Study of Democracy and Citizenship
 - *Prof. Taylor Owens*: Media Ecosystem Observatory, Max Bell School of Public Policy.

Junior Attaché, General Delegation of Quebec in New York

Fall 2021

- ◇ Internship, Economic and Public Affairs

Coordinator, Raoul Dandurand Chair in Strategic and Diplomatic Studies June 2020- June 2021

- ◇ Center for US Studies: coordination of SSHRC funded research and events on US-Canada relations.

PEER-REVIEWED
PUBLICATIONS

4. (Under review) "Russia's Narrative Dominance Beyond the West: Constructing an Alternative Information Order", co-authored with Jean Christophe Boucher (U Calgary) and Israa Farouk (U Calgary),
3. (Under review) "The Sources and Limits of European Influence on Public Opinion in EU Candidate Countries", co-authored with Aaron Erlich (McGill University),
2. (Forthcoming) "Taiwan-China Relations Coverage in Canadian Media", co-authored with Katie Zheng (Wake Forest University) and Jean Christophe Boucher (U Calgary), *International Journal*
1. (2024) "Baby You Can Drive My Car? L'impact de la présidence Trump sur l'industrie automobile canado-américaine" in Gagnon, F., Cloutier-Roy C (dir.) , *L'Amérique d'abord, le Canada ensuite. Les relations canado-américaines de Donald Trump à Joe Biden*, Presses de l'Université de Montréal.

WORKING PAPERS

2. "Between Exit and Integration: Crypto and the Politics of Institutionalization in Europe".
1. "Short Videos, Long Wars: Chinese Foreign Information Operations in the United States on TikTok", co-authored with Jean Christophe Boucher (UCalgary).

CONFERENCES
AND PRESENTATIONS

9. "Making Sense of TikTok Political Disinformation Using Computer Vision Methods: A Research Agenda", paper to be presented at the 2025 International Studies Association in Chicago, March 2025.
8. "Russian Propaganda in the Global South: Pathways Towards Collective Inoculation Using Deep Learning Language Models", paper to be presented at the American Political Science Association Conference, Philadelphia, September 2024.
7. "Whispers From the Kremlin: Russian Propaganda in the West Amidst the Invasion of Ukraine", paper presented at the International Studies Association Conference, San Francisco, April 2024.
6. "Digital Authoritarianism and Russia's Disinformation amidst the War in Ukraine", paper presented at the American Political Science Association Conference, Los Angeles, August 2023.
5. "The Impact of Western Driven Sanctions on Russian Public Opinion Amidst the Invasion of Ukraine", presented at the Midwestern Political Science Association Conference, Chicago, April 2023.
4. "Demystifying Russia's Disinformation Strategy Changes Amidst the Invasion of Ukraine using Machine Learning", paper presented at the Northeastern Political Science Association Conference, Boston, November 2022.
3. "The Russo-American Relationship in the Eye of the Russian Diaspora in the United States", research presented at the annual research day of the Quebec Network of Postsoviet Studies (Réseau Québécois d'Études Postsoviétiques), University of Montreal, May 27th, 2022. This research was also presented in November 2021 during the Quebec Political Science Society Student Colloquium.
2. "From Sevastopol to Kyiv: The Failure to Establish a Post Cold War Order to Understand the War in Ukraine" paper presented at the Carleton University Political Science Graduate Conference. Ottawa, April 20th, 2022.
1. "Broken Links? Trump, Biden and the Detroit-Windsor Auto Industry," book chapter presented at the 26th Biennial Conference of the Association for Canadian Studies in the United States. Washington D.C. November 2021 (reported in 2024 due to COVID).

HONOURS AND AWARDS

15. Canadian Graduate Scholarship for Doctoral Programs. (\$40,000 CAD/year) . Awarded from May 2023 until May 2026.
14. Social Science and Humanities Research Council Doctoral Fellowship . (\$40,000 CAD/year) . Awarded from May 2023 until May 2027
13. Graduate Mobility Award, McGill University. (\$ 6,000 CAD). Awarded for Fall 2026 dissertation fieldwork.
12. Jean Monet Centre Montreal Fieldwork Scholarship. University of Montreal/McGill University. (\$ 2,850 EUR). Awarded for Fall 2026 dissertation fieldwork.
11. Doctoral Excellence Research Grant, McGill University Department of Political Science. (\$22,000 CAD/year) . Awarded from Fall 2022 until May 2027.
10. Institute for Qualitative and Mixed-Method Research (Syracuse University) Workshop Grant (\$ 3,000 USD value). Awarded in June 2025.
9. McGill University Arts Faculty Graduate Student Teaching Award. Awarded in March 2025.
8. Centre for International Peace and Security Studies Research Training and Traveling Grant (\$ 500 CAD). Awarded for 2024-2025 methods training initiatives.
7. Honors distinction for Master's dissertation. Granted January 2022.
6. Excellence scholarship for the Faculty of Management of the University of Quebec in Montreal (\$1,100 CAD) . Awarded January & March 2022.
5. Bourse J.A. DeSève (\$4,000 CAD). Awarded June 2021.
4. Bourse institutionnelle de soutien à la réussite (\$4,000 CAD). Awarded December 2020 and 2021.
3. Marc Bourgie Internship Grant (\$10,000 CAD). Awarded June 2020.
2. Bourse Desjardins de la Caisse de d'Au-tray pour les cycles supérieurs (\$1,000 CAD). Awarded June 2018
1. UQAM Mobility Award (\$3,000 CAD). Awarded January 2018.

TEACHING

4. POLI 331: Politics of East Central Europe, McGill University, Fall 2024 (Lecturer)
3. POLI 329: Russian and Soviet Politics, McGill University, Winter 2023/2024 (Teaching Assistant)
2. POLI 346: US Foreign Policy, McGill University, Fall 2022 (Teaching Assistant)
1. Geopolitical Issues of Russia and Ukraine, University of Sherbrooke (Third age university), Fall 2022 (Lecturer)

RESEARCH INTERESTS

My primary research examines the political economy of digital finance, with a focus on cryptocurrency communities, financial authority, and state-market relations in Europe and North America. I study how actors operating in crypto and blockchain ecosystems navigate, contest, and bargain with regulatory institutions, and how these interactions reshape governance, legitimacy, and the organization of financial systems. My work is grounded in comparative and international political economy and engages broader questions related to post-communist development, informal economic practices, and the transformation of digital markets.

I also research information politics and strategic communication, including Russian foreign messaging, and incorporate computational approaches to the study of political narratives and influence.

Methodologically, I employ a mixed-methods approach combining qualitative and quantitative techniques. My qualitative work draws on interviews, fieldwork observation, and archival and primary-source analysis. On the quantitative side, I use advanced data analysis in R and Python, including machine learning, natural language processing (NLP), and text-as-data methods. Across projects, I emphasize causal inference, leveraging both experimental and observational research designs to identify and evaluate political and economic mechanisms.

METHODOLOGICAL SKILLS **Coding and publishing:**

- ◊ Intermediate/Advanced: R, Python, Excel, LaTeX, Quarto.
- ◊ Working proficiency: Git, SQL, PowerBI.

Methods training & experience:

- ◊ Institute for Qualitative and Multi-Method Research, Syracuse University, Summer 2025.
- ◊ Quantitative methods & causal inference courses: POLI 666: Causal Inference for Political Science, Instructor: Prof. Elisa Berwick, McGill University; POLI 618 Quantitative Analysis, Prof. Aaron Erlich, McGill University, Fall 2023/Winter 2025.
- ◊ Qualitative (fieldwork, interview, and archival research) Course: (POLI 660 Fieldwork: Challenges and Strategies), Prof. Tania Islas Weinstein, McGill University, Fall 2023.
- ◊ Quarto workshop on website creation and publishing, instructor: Prof. Elisa Berwick, McGill University, Winter 2024.
- ◊ Machine learning for text analysis workshop, organized by the Network for Strategic Analysis, Instructors: Prof. Jean Christophe Boucher & Jenny Kim, University of Calgary and University of Quebec at Montreal, Summer 2023.

RESEARCH PROJECTS

6. Dissertation research on the political economy of digital finance, examining how cryptocurrency communities interact with state institutions and financial regulators in Europe and North America. The project focuses on processes of bargaining, legitimacy, and institutional integration in emerging digital financial markets.
5. Research on Russian and Chinese misinformation, machine learning, natural language processing and computer vision methods, directed by Prof. Jean Christophe Boucher, University of Calgary, SSHRC and MINDS programs funded.
4. Research on computer vision methods to identify and classify foreign disinformation on Tik Tok, directed by Jean Christophe Boucher, University of Calgary.
3. Survey research on Russian, Chinese and Indian diasporas and home communities media consumption and political behaviour. Directed by Prof. Aaron Erlich (McGill Centre for the Study of Democracy and Citizenship) and Aengus Bridgman (McGill Media Ecosystem Observatory).
2. Joint research with Prof. Juliet Johnson on the Western perceptions of Russian-targeting sanctions efficacy from 2014 to the invasion of Ukraine (McGill University).
1. Research on the impact of Russian imperialist actions in Ukraine and the impact on democratic and identity trajectories in Ukraine and Europe (SSHRC Funded).

PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATIONS

- ◊ **Member:** *Laboratory on Democracy, Transparency, Information Provision and Participation* (dir. Aaron Erlich) - Centre for the Study of Democratic Citizenship - McGill University.
- ◊ **Member:** *Centre for International Peace and Security Studies*, McGill University.
- ◊ **Emerging Scholar:** *Network for Strategic Analysis*, University of Québec at Montreal - Queens University.
- ◊ **Associate Fellow:** *Raoul Dandurand Chair in Strategic and Diplomatic Studies* - Center for US Studies, University of Quebec at Montreal.

LANGUAGE SKILLS French, English (native fluency); Russian (elementary proficiency); Spanish (reading elementary proficiency).